

(Following added to unfinished letter of July 26, 1951.)

Sept. 17, 1951 - God bless you Rev. Mother Mary Hilda. I hope this finds you - still on the way of the cross, the best school wherein to learn appreciation for and love of Jesus Crucified divine lover of souls. Our friend Miss B. from Decatur was here this P. M. with her two sisters, niece-in-law and little girl, - pleasantly surprised on hearing of your visit, etc. Afterwards I just came across the above started letter which I had pulled out of the machine about a month ago to get something off that seemed more immediately urgent. So, hoping that it is not too late or too inopportune I'm sending it just as it is. However, as a sort of key to the letter from Miss Gibson which I gave you Sunday, I am going to try to get a copy for you of the letter she wrote me a week or so before the trial when things seemed so very threatening. I am sure you will enjoy it - as heightening the interest and beauty of the one that followed. An obvious lesson it ought to stress, as seems to me, is the old adage or motto: "Per aspera ad astra", - "Through trials to triumph": or straight prose as St. Paul gives it: "It behooves by many tribulations, to enter into the Kingdom of Heaven."

Bless'd be God again in all His designs - not only including them simply - but stressing the trials, the humiliations, crosses, disappointments, etc. whereby, next to the reception of the holy Sacraments in importance, it would seem divinely providential that those whose motto ought to be: "ALWAYS EXCELSIOR", be purified from self conceit, so natural to originally tainted human reason, and introduced gradually into the light and intimacy of confidence with the Divine.

Glory be to God. Deo Gratias
Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.